

TURKEY

Turkey's climate is well suited to growing tea and the nation has developed quite a thirst for the beverage. The average person drinks up to 10 cups of tea per day of "Çay," the traditional black tea served strong and sweet.

Tea is grown in the picturesque province of Rize in northeast Turkey, an area located between the Pontic mountains and the Black Sea. Characterized by high temperatures and evenly distributed rainfall throughout the year, the humid, subtropical climate of this region is ideal for growing tea. In addition, cooler nights make it possible to grow tea without the use of pesticides.

The Rize province is quite rural and was an economically poor area before tea was first planted there in the 1940s. Since then tea

production has spread along the local coastline of the Black Sea. The tea industry in Turkey now produces almost as much tea as Sri Lanka and has made a significant contribution to the local economy. Only 5 percent of Turkish-grown tea is exported and the government imposes a 145 percent import tariff on tea imports, ensuring that domestic consumption remains high.

Turkey is one of the few countries outside Italy to grow bergamot citrus, a principal ingredient in Earl Grey tea.

EUROPE



TURKEY KEY FACTS

PERCENTAGE
OF WORLD
PRODUCTION:

4.6%

MAIN TYPES:

BLACK (CTC)

HARVEST:

MAY–OCTOBER

FAMOUS FOR:

**HIGH DOMESTIC
CONSUMPTION
TEA GROWN
WITHOUT
PESTICIDES**

ELEVATION:

MEDIUM

KEY



NOTABLE TEA-
PRODUCING REGIONS



AREA OF PRODUCTION